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"And the barbarous people showed us no little kindness: for they kindled a fire, and received us every one, because of the present rain, and because of the cold. And when Paul had gathered a bundle of sticks together, and laid them on the fire, there came a viper out of the heat, and fastened on his hand."—ACTS xxviii, 2, 3, &c.,

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THE ROYAL NAVY—ANCIENT AND MODERN.*

(Continued from page 66.)

BY daybreak on the morning of the 2nd of June, 1666, the four days' battle off Dunkirk was resumed, but previous to this a council of war had been held by candlelight on board the head-quarter ship, wherein the Duke of Albemarle delivered this opinion: "That if we had dreaded the number of the enemy yesterday we should have fled, but though we are inferior to them in ships, we are in all things else superior. Force gives them courage. Let us, if we need it, borrow resolution from what we have formerly performed. Let the enemy feel that though our fleet be divided (referring to the absence of the White Squadron), our spirit is entire. At the worst it will be more honourable to die here on our own element than be made spectacles to the Dutch. To be overcome is the fortune of war, but to fly is the fashion of cowards. So let us teach the world that Englishmen would rather be acquainted with death than fear."

These noble words elicited a burst of applause; every captain repaired to his ship, and the action was at once renewed, with, if possible, increased fury, a few hours' pause only occurring by the intervention of a calm, till about noon, when a breeze sprang up. Van Tromp, before the wind, rashly bore into the midst of the English fleet, and being raked on all sides, had a narrow escape, and had once more, as on the preceding day,

* From "British Battles on Land and Sea," by James Grant; Cassell & Co., and other sources.

being full in the breakers, it was seen that it must soon break up. In vain the lifeboat's crew entreated, they were warned off, and had to leave; but seeing the loss of life that must ensue, the lifeboat's coxswain determined to return, and this time was so far successful that five of the crew jumped off and were picked up. The captain still remained obstinate, and at length a Coast-guardman named Gould volunteered for the perilous duty of going out to the wreck along the rocket-line, taking with him a letter from the French Consul, urging the captain to leave. In the presence of hundreds of intensely excited spectators, Gould steadily made his way, being often under the water for several seconds and imminently in danger of being washed off. The captain was watching him from the bridge, but when under the bows would lend no aid, and, the furious sea breaking over him, Gould was washed away, and it was feared he must perish. Happily, however, he regained the rope, and, more dead than alive, was washed and dragged ashore. Meanwhile the vessel was fast breaking up, the masts fell over the side, the stern, on which the captain was standing, was broken off, and it was supposed he had sunk, but presently he was seen among the wreckage, and mounted to the foreyard, the sail of which somewhat sheltered him. The Coastguard fired two more rockets, and, one line falling close to the captain, he seized it, but even then seemed irresolute whether to save himself or perish with the ship. After a quarter of an hour, however, the love of life constrained him to fasten the rope around him, and he was dragged ashore. Within an hour nothing was to be seen of the vessel but a few floating spars. The cheers which greeted the captain's rescue were by no means so hearty as those which had welcomed the return of Gould, whose life had been risked in attempting to save him.

disco, Call contains an interesting account of an Indian woman who was accidentally abandoned on San Nicolas Island, off the coast of Southern California, and spent eighteen years alone there before she was rescued. The fact of her existence was discovered by a man who went from the mainland to hunt for otters, and who found footprints sunk deeply in the ground. He was unable to follow up these indications till nearly three years, when one of a party who accompanied him came suddenly upon the object of their search. She was in a small circular enclosure made of brushwood, about five feet high and six feet in diameter, with a small opening on one side. She was clothed with a garment made of skins of the shag, a species of duck that can neither walk nor fly. This garment reached almost to her ankles when she stood erect. She was sitting cross-legged, skinning seal-blubber with a rude knife made of a piece of hoop-iron driven into a piece of wood. There was no covering on her head, except a thick matted mass of hair, of yellowish-brown colour, probably owing to exposure to the sun and the weather. It was short, as if the ends had rotted off. There were some wild dogs on the island, a few of which kept near her, and seemed to regard her as a mistress. She had lived on a plant resembling cabbage, called by Californians *palo santo*, and a root known by the name of *corcomite*, also blubber of the various kinds of seals, &c. She had a rude apparatus for catching shell-fish, and strong fishing-lines made of seal sinews, which seemed to indicate that she fished in the ocean. The expression of her face was pleasing, her features were regular, her complexion much fairer and her form more symmetrical than that of the Indian women on the adjoining mainland. Some suspect that she belonged to a tribe much farther north. She could not understand anything said to her in any of the Indian dialects of South California, but she had a wonderful capacity for conversing by

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A FEMALE CRUSOE.—The San Fran-

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signs. She retained all her teeth, but they were worn low, supposed to be due to her chewing tough and hard articles of food. Her age appeared to be about fifty years. She bowed to all who came near her, greeting them with a smile. She freely accompanied her discoverers to their vessel, but her conduct at once convinced them that she retained the virtue of female modesty. She showed singular dexterity in making water-vessels from grass and asphaltum, a substance which is plentiful both on the island and the mainland. She seemed to recognise various appliances of civilisation. She died about seven weeks after reaching the mainland, partly from the effects of a fall, and partly from dysentery, brought on by eating fruits and vegetables. Padre Gonzalaz, the superior of the mission of Santa Barbara, has sent her dress of shag-skins, her basket, and implements, to Rome, to the Museum of the Propaganda.

THE LOSS OF THE 'CLYDE'.—The account furnished by Colonel Davies, of the Grenadier Guards, who was in charge of the troops on board the transport 'Clyde' when the vessel was lost, recalls forcibly to mind the loss of the 'Birkenhead' under circumstances which, weather alone excepted, were very similar. The vessels ran aground near the same spot, they were both loaded with soldiers and military stores, and both foundered. But there the similarity ends; for the gallant fellows on board the 'Birkenhead' perished, while every life on board the 'Clyde' was saved. How this was managed is told in simple language by Colonel Davies. The ship ran aground at half-past four in the morning, and Colonel Davies was promptly informed by the officer of the watch. The other officers were at once summoned, the assembly was sounded, and "the men fell in with the greatest order and regularity." Sentries were then posted over the boats and spirit room, and within half an hour the work of disembarkation was com-

menced. Breakfast was prepared for all without hurry or confusion; the sick were got ready, together with stores of tea, preserved meats, biscuits, and water, and soon despatched for shore in the two lifeboats; then when the boats returned the soldiers were sent off in relays from ship to land, apparently with clockwork regularity. Shortly after one o'clock the last soldier having entered the boats, the colonel with a brother officer, also left the ship, which was then sinking fast, although she did not disappear until nightfall. How nearly the fate of the 'Clyde' might have resembled that of the 'Birkenhead' is evident from a remark of Colonel Davies, that "if the wind had freshened or veered to the west, within half an hour nobody would have been able to land."

SEABIRDS AND FISH.—It is well known that sea birds eat fish, but few people have any idea of the quantity they consume. According to the report of a commission appointed to inquire into the herring fishery, Scotch gannets consume more than 1,110,000,000 herrings per annum. It is also calculated that codfish and its congeners consume about 20,400,000,000 per annum. Compared with these birds and fishes, man makes a poor figure in taking the herring. Upon an average the number of herrings caught by fishermen is estimated at 843,250,800 per annum, a very thin show compared with the long figures given above. Yet there are 7,000 boats now fishing for herrings in the Scottish seas with nets which could be made to reach in a continuous line for nearly 12,000 miles, and cover a superficial area of 70 square miles. Notwithstanding this and also the fact that the power of capture has been increased, the results have not proved satisfactory, and the take of herring has been much below what it should be. Herrings are known to be extremely prolific, but judging from the figures given they are principally consumed by fishes and birds.

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